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LARGE The Silk Velvet Arc

large An Urban Intrigue Adventure for *Fate's Edge*

Tiers IIII — 610 sessions — Social maneuvering, ritual peril, political theatre

rule

What This Is

A complete, tableready arc set across the tradebridge city of **Silkstrand**, a night of high etiquette at **Ravenswood Manor**, and the stairruled metropolis of **Thepyrgos**. Themes: contracts and crowds; masks and glamour; law as performance. The adventure emphasizes ¶osition play, interlocking timers, and a flavorful §B economy.

At a Glance

tem **Part I A Song of Poison and Plague** (Tier III): Urban investigation as the Gemcutters and Alchemists edge toward riots while a bard of Desire plays both sides. tem **Part II The Gilded Cage** (Tier IIII): Survive a night of velvet hospitality; each room is a social encounter with taboos and tells. tem **Part III The Crimson Masque** (Tier III): A public ritual threatens to swap the souls of the city's elite with the troupe; stop it on stage before the final bell.

System Notes. Use the game's Position ladder and to make leverage matter. Cityspecific s represent codified outcomes (permits, seats, escorts) that shift ¶osition without a roll. Timers pace consequences. The GM spends §B when 1s appear to twist crowds, shift law, or advance rails.

Adventure Background

Silkstrand sits over dyed waterways and legal bridges; permits and seals are visible power. Two guilds**Gemcutters** and **Alchemists**blame each other for “poisoned” water. **Sel Virelle**, a charismatic devotee of Desire, orchestrates paranoia to ripen the city for a prestige heist by the **Crimson Masque** troupe, agents of Glamour. Their endgame plays out in Thepyrgos, where belllaw and stairrights can crown or crush reputations overnight.

Session Count Tier Flow

Intended for 610 sessions. Start at Tier I, crest at Tier III. Each part includes typical and ¶osition guidance to ease scaling.

Core Tools for the GM

Position DV Quick Reference

	rule	Position	Typical DV	Examples of Fic- tional Ad- van- tage
	rule	Dominant	+2	You hold per- mits, the crowd fa- vors you, law is on your side.
		Dominant	+3	Proper in- tro- duc- tions, sta- ble foot- ing, watch is neu- tral.
linewidth		Controlled	+4	Time pres- sure, hos- tile wit- nesses, par- tial lever- age.
		Desperate	+5 or more	No per- mits, hos- tile crowd, taboo bro-

Typical DVs by Part

rule	Part	Common DV Range	Notes
rule I: Silkstrand		34	Documents and Di- a- monds can drop DV by 1 be- fore rolling. Etiquette taboos raise DV; read- ing tells can lower DV by 1.
II: Ravenswood		45	Public rit- ual ac- tions start high; dis- man- tling pil- lars low- ers DV.
III: Thepyrgos		56	
linewidth			
tomrule			

Diamonds as Leverage

rule	Diamond	Fiction Effect
		Au- thor- ity
rule	Matron's Audience	You Shift ¶osition one step up once/scene; 1 DV on petitions. may pe- ti- tion Silk- strand's Ma- tron in ses- sion.
	Arsenal Key	Authorized session, declare gear or evidence "on hand". ac- cess to a guild ar- mory or lockup.
linewidth	Bellmark	A Once/scene, freeze a crowd or call watch for 1 beat. stamped right to in- voke bel- llaw in Thep- yr- gos.
	StairPass	Priority Downshift ¶osition consequences from crowd pressure. use of a named stair dur- ing events.
	Escort Writ	Legal Ignore one blockade or mob once/session. es- cort through mar-

SB Spend Menus (Use When 1s Appear)

Silkstrand

tem Bridge duel erupts nearby; escalate a scene or split the party. tem Market panic closes a route; add 1 to a public timer. tem Dyewater omen flips the crowd's mood against the PCs. tem Notary "corrects" a permit; ¶osition downshift for one exchange.

Ravenswood Manor

tem Etiquette whisper spreads; tick Etiquette Breach1. tem Hospitality favors a rival; your next roll is at higher DV. tem Servant intervention reroutes you to a new room at a cost.

Thepyrgos

tem Bell strikes early; advance the Act timer. tem Stairright revoked temporarily; block or split routes. tem Law change midscene; transform a planned action's ¶osition.

Timers to Start With

Keep timers lean at first; layer more as play demands.

tem City Unrest6 (Silkstrand) tem Poisonings4 (Silkstrand) tem Sel's Glamour Net4 tem Choose *one* guild reputation to track first: Gemcutters' Favor4 *or* Alchemists' Favor4

Part I A Song of Poison and Plague (Tier III)

Strong Hooks (Choose 12 to Open)

tem **Dyewater Omen:** The river runs a prophetic hue; the crowd demands action from anyone wearing steel or sigils. tem **Bridge Duel Gone Wrong:** A fatal misstep during a public duel implicates a guild; the watch seeks neutral witnesses (the PCs). tem **Missing Ledgers:** Archivolt records vanish; without them, permits are void and riots loom.

Core Timers

City Unrest6, Poisonings4, Sel's Glamour Net4, plus one Guild Favor timer.

Key NPCs

tem **Guildmistress Kavra (Gemcutters)** *Desires:* stability, monopoly on luxury. *Leverage:* bravos, patronage. *Tell:* rubs thumb over a signet when lying. tem **Master Orun (Alchemists)** *Desires:* legitimacy, funding. *Leverage:* inspectors, antidotes. *Tell:* recites measurements under stress. tem **Sel Virelle (Bard of Desire)** *Desires:* acclaim, volatility. *Leverage:* charmed witnesses. *Tell:* mirrors phrasing to draw agreement.

Scenes

Redwater Audit. Enter the dyeworks with forged or earned permits. ¶osition starts Dominant; DV 34. On success with sb, allow entry but spend §B to tick Poisonings+1 or call an Alchemist observer. *Magic:* Alchemical detection, illusions to mimic stamps, or subtle glammers to steer crowds shine here.

Alleyway Serenade. Sel “rescues” a bystander from a mob to win PC trust. Reading her tells can downshift DV. Failure forward: the PCs earn a (Escort Writ) but tick Sel’s Glamour Net+1.

Three Queens Duel. A formal bridge duel settles a permit dispute. Stakes: purse, permit, or pride. Victory can clear 1 from a Guild Favor timer; loss still reveals a planted second’s testimony.

Archivolt Ledgers. Track falsified entries to a clerks’ circle. Options: bribe (Diamonds), debate in public (drop DV by 1 with a crowd), or stealth (risk Desperate). On a miss, the ledgers you *do* find implicate an ally as leverage later.

Climax Options

tem **Public Debate at Lion Bridge:** Expose Sel. If you sway the crowd, cool City Unrest². If you fail, you still win a legal foothold but Glamour Net+2. tem **Quiet Sabotage:** Collapse distribution of forged evidence; gain a permanent (Matron’s Audience) but sour one guild permanently. tem **Arrest Bargain:** Trade Sel’s testimony for guild peace; start Part II with social capital at Ravenswood.

Fail Forward Examples (Part I).

tem *Audit Miss:* You are barred, but a junior clerk slips you an *appointment chit* (treat as a temporary) and the watch starts tailing you. tem *Duel Miss:* You lose the bout, but the crowd turns on the victor over a rule infraction; shift ¶osition up in the next public scene. tem *Ledger Heist Miss:* You grab the wrong ledger; it names a friend. Keep it and gain leverage, or return it and earn a favor.

Part II The Gilded Cage (Tier IIII)

Structure

Track Midnight Duel⁸ (the rival’s plot) and Etiquette Breach⁴ (your faux pas). Every room lists an *Intent*, a *Taboo*, and a *Tell*. Violating taboos increases DV or ticks Etiquette Breach+1. Reading tells can reduce DV by 1.

Rooms

Conservatory of Masks. *Intent:* choose alliances. *Taboo:* wearing the same mask twice. *Tell:* a rival never mirrors your stance. *Magic:* Disguises and glamours gain a clear advantage; clever illusions can “prove” etiquette creatively.

Library of Additions. *Intent:* alter contracts with lawful flourishes. *Taboo:* citing a text you cannot produce. *Tell:* a steward coughs before lies. *Magic:* Divination or memory magic can surface the missing clause; ritual ink resists forgery unless properly countered.

Ballroom of Vows. *Intent:* demonstrate poise. *Taboo:* cutting a trio dance to two. *Tell:* a partner flinches at touch. *Magic:* Subtle enchantments risk taboos; protective magic can prevent social harm without force.

Outcomes

tem **Favor the Host:** Gain introductionsbegin Part III with a Bellmark. tem **Favor the Challenger (Glamourtouched):** Receive access to the Masque’s rehearsal; start Act I behind the curtain. tem **Seize the Venue:** Control the guest list that matters later; start with ¶osition at Dominant for Act I scene one.

FailForward Examples (Part II).

tem *Mask Faux Pas:* Etiquette Breach+1, but you notice a hidden sidedoor used by rivals. tem *Contract Gaffe:* Your addition is rejected publicly; the steward, impressed by your boldness, offers a private reading later (lower DV once). tem *Dance Misstep:* You stumble, but hear a whispered cue that reveals the rival’s schedule.

Part III The Crimson Masque (Tier III)

Act Structure

Run as a threeday countdown to the final performance.

tem **Act I (Day 3):** Infiltrate rehearsals, court patrons, secure stair access. tem **Act II (Day 2/1):** Decode the rite; seed counters in law, masks, or music. tem **Act III (Performance Night):** Onstage skill challenge; illusions are real; dismantle ritual pillars.

Ritual Pillars (Break One to Stop the Rite)

tem **Bell Cadence:** The final peal synchronizes souls. Counter with belllaw, a forged bellmark, or a timed silence. tem **Mask Index:** Masks hold targeted identities. Swap labels, smudge index entries, or sanctify a mask to render it immune. tem **Applause Escrow:** The ovation stores consent. Split the crowd, mute applause, or redirect acclaim to the troupe alone.

OnStage Challenge (Guidance)

Start at DV 6 (Desperate). Each broken pillar lowers DV by 1 and shifts ¶osition up. Failureforward should always change the stage: a mask cracks, a bell peals offtime, an actor falters.

Endings

tem **Expose Redirect:** Law halts the rite; only the willing swap. Reputation boons carry forward. tem **Strike in Glamour:** Duel within unfolding illusions while allies sever a pillar. tem **Take the Price:** Bargain with Glamour or Desire; end the rite, owe a favor.

NPC Roster (QuickUse)

rule Name	Desires, Lever- age, Tell, Voice
rule Guildmistress Kavra	Stability; bravos, pa- tron- age; signet rub; clipped, eco- nom- i- cal speech.
Master Orun	Legitimacy; in- spec- tors, an- ti- dotes; mut- tered mea- sures; care- ful, ex- act.
Sel Virelle	Applause; charmed wit- nesses; mir- rored phras- ing; warm, ris- ing ca- dence.
linewidth	
Lord/Host of Ravenswood	Prestige; hos- pi- tal- ity

Appendix A: Session 1 Outline (3 Hours)

tem **Cold Open (15 min)**: Choose a hook; paint the crowd; surface a visible Diamond (Escort Writ in a steward's hand). tem **Investigation Beat (45 min)**: Redwater Audit or Missing Ledgers. Offer Position shifts via Diamonds. tem **Pressure Beat (30 min)**: Alleyway Serenade or Bridge Duel challenge. tem **Choice Beat (30 min)**: Which guild gets aid? Start one Guild Favor timer. tem **Climax (3040 min)**: Public minidebate or duel; on any miss, spend §B to tick Sel's Glamour Net+1. tem **Fallout (10 min)**: Hand out one Diamond; foreshadow Ravenswood with a sealed invitation.

Appendix B: Printable Timers

City Unrest6fill
Poisonings4fill
Sel's Glamour Net4fill
Gemcutters' Favor4fill Alchemists' Favor4fill
Midnight Duel8fill
Etiquette Breach4fill
Act Countdown6fill

Appendix C: PlayerFacing Rumors (Silkstrand)

tem "Gemcutters bribe the river with rubies; the water drinks poorly of greed." tem "Alchemists dump antidote precursors at dawnno poison, just panic." tem "A singer can still a riot if the key is true."